Endometrial Biopsy

A simple office procedure to evaluate abnormal uterine bleeding — what to expect and why it's done

❓ WHAT IS AN ENDOMETRIAL BIOPSY?

An endometrial biopsy (EMB) is a **simple office procedure** that takes a small tissue sample from the lining of your uterus (endometrium). The sample is sent to pathology to check for abnormal cells, cancer, or other conditions.

- ⏰ Usually takes 5–10 minutes in our office
- 💉 No sedation required — you stay awake and can drive yourself home
- 🔬 Can diagnose hyperplasia, polyps, infection, or cancer
- 📊 Provides tissue for definitive diagnosis when imaging isn't enough

💡 **EMB is often performed to evaluate postmenopausal bleeding or abnormal uterine bleeding in premenopausal women.**

📋 REASONS FOR AN EMB

- 🩸 **Abnormal uterine bleeding** — heavy, prolonged, or irregular periods
- 🎗️ **Postmenopausal bleeding** (any bleeding after menopause)
- 🔬 **Abnormal ultrasound findings** (thickened endometrium, polyps)
- 💊 **Before starting hormone therapy** (if high risk)
- 🧬 **Evaluation of infertility** in some cases
- 📊 **Monitoring** of endometrial hyperplasia on treatment

Most common reason: women age ≥45 with abnormal bleeding to rule out endometrial cancer.

⚕ DURING THE PROCEDURE

- 🩺 You'll lie on the exam table as for a Pap smear
- 🧴 A speculum is inserted into your vagina
- 🧼 The cervix is cleansed with antiseptic solution
- 🔍 A thin, flexible catheter (Pipelle, Tao Brush) is passed through the cervix into the uterus
- 💉 Gentle suction or brushing collects a small tissue sample
- 😣 You may feel **cramping similar to a strong menstrual cramp** for 30–60 seconds
- 💊 You can take ibuprofen 600–800mg 1 hour before to reduce cramping

🚨 The procedure is **contraindicated in pregnancy** — a negative pregnancy test is required before biopsy.

🏠 AFTER THE BIOPSY

- 😌 Cramping usually subsides within minutes to an hour
- 💊 Take ibuprofen or prescribed pain medication as needed
- 🩸 Light spotting or bleeding for 1–3 days is normal
- 🛏️ You can return to normal activities the same day
- 🚫 Avoid sexual intercourse, tampons, and douching for 1 week
- ⏰ Results typically take 5–7 business days
- 📞 We will call you with results and discuss next steps

🚨 **Call Us If You Experience:**

- 🔥 Fever >100.4°F
- 🩸 Heavy bleeding (soaking a pad every hour)
- 😫 Severe or worsening abdominal pain
- 🤢 Foul-smelling discharge

💚

Peace of Mind Through Accurate Diagnosis

An endometrial biopsy provides crucial information to guide your care. While the cramping can be uncomfortable, it's brief and often less intense than feared. We perform hundreds of biopsies each year with minimal complications. Please don't hesitate to ask questions before, during, or after the procedure. 💚 — **(281) 557-0300**